

Handout 5.2: What Clothing Says, and the Class Agreement

Name: _____ Date: _____ Period: _____

The rule for today: We talk about clothing. We do not talk about each other's clothes. Nobody in this room has to explain or defend what they are wearing.

Directions: Fill in Part 1 and Part 2 during the slides and the shirt demonstration. Fill in Part 3 during the culture and generation slides. Copy the class agreement into Part 4 at the end and sign it if you agree to it.

Word bank in other languages

[Check with a native speaker before printing.]

English	Turkish	Portuguese	Spanish
impression	izlenim	impressão	impresión
communication	iletişim	comunicação	comunicación
nonverbal	sözsüz	não verbal	no verbal
uniform	üniforma	uniforme	uniforme
costume	kostüm	fantasia (traje)	disfraz
culture	kültür	cultura	cultura
respect	saygı	respeito	respeto
agreement	anlaşma	acordo	acuerdo
setting	ortam	ambiente (situação)	entorno (situación)
audience	izleyici (karşıdaki kişi)	público	público

Part 1: Clothing is communication

People communicate through four channels. Fill in the missing ones and give an example of each.

Channel	What it is	An example
1. Words	The words you choose	
2. Voice		
3. Body		
4. Appearance		

Clothing lives in channel number ____.



A uniform says: _____

A costume says: _____

One sentence: what has to be true for a costume to work?

Part 2: The same shirt, three settings

One shirt. Three settings. Fill in the grid.

Setting	What the shirt says here	Who is reading it
A job interview		
A family cookout		
A school hallway		

Finish the sentence: The shirt did not change. What changed was _____

Part 3: Culture and generations

3a. Write one example of clothing that carries cultural meaning. You can use one from the slide or one you know.



3b. Finish this sentence in your own words: “It is just a costume” does not work for cultural dress because



3c. Name one thing about clothing that has changed between your parents' or grandparents' generation and yours.

3d. What did adults say about what your parents or grandparents wore at your age?



Part 4: Our class agreement

The class writes this together. Copy the final lines here.

What is okay to say about what somebody is wearing











What is not okay to say about what somebody is wearing











The line I nominated: _____

My reason for it: _____

I agree to this. Signed: _____ Date: _____

Exit card (tear off or write on an index card)

1. One line from our agreement you will actually use:



2. One thing clothing says without words:



3. One question you still have:



Teacher key

Part 1, the four channels.

Channel	What it is	Example
Words	The words you choose	Saying “I can help you with that”
Voice	Tone, volume, speed, pauses	The same sentence said warmly or flatly
Body	Face, hands, posture, distance, eye contact	Arms crossed, a shrug, turning away
Appearance	Clothing, grooming, what you carry	A suit, a uniform, a team shirt

Clothing lives in channel 4, appearance.

A uniform says: what job or role the person has, what group or team they belong to, that they are on duty, who to ask for help. Personal choice is taken off the table on purpose.

A costume says: this is not me today, it is temporary, and it is on purpose.

What has to be true for a costume to work: the person wearing it and the people looking at it both have to know it is a costume.

Part 2, the same shirt. Answers vary; a Meets answer names something different in each row and the “what changed” sentence names the setting or the audience, not the shirt. Common correct answers: interview, “I am serious and I prepared,” read by a manager; cookout, “I am comfortable and I am family,” read by relatives; hallway, “this is my normal,” read by classmates. A student who writes the same thing in all three rows has missed the point; ask “who is reading it in row 1 versus row 3?”

Part 3. 3a: any accurate example. Items named on the slide are a hijab, a sari, a kilt, a kente cloth, a guayabera, a kufi, and a huipil. Accept family or community examples the student knows. 3b: because an item that belongs to a living culture is somebody’s real clothing, not a temporary pretend, and treating it as a costume says their real life is a joke. 3c and 3d: answers vary; the point of 3d is that every generation got criticized and every generation thought it was unfair.

Part 4, the agreement. There is no key, because the class writes it. Lines that usually come up and are worth steering toward:

Okay to say: a compliment about the item, not about the body; “where is that from”; “I like your jacket”; nothing at all; a question asked once, privately, and dropped if the answer is short.

Not okay to say: pricing somebody’s clothes out loud, real or guessed; commenting on the same person twice; “you always wear that”; a joke about a religious or cultural item; a comment about whether clothing fits somebody’s body; saying it online about a photo.



Score Objective 3 from who nominated a line and gave a reason, noted on the clipboard during the discussion. The signed chart paper is the class artifact and stays posted through Lesson 5.18.

Standards checked by this handout: NYS ATPD 1. Selection b) and c); CTE CIR 1. Communication b) and c); NYS FACS Standard 2 (Intermediate) PI C; CDOS 3a Interpersonal Skills; National FCS 3.0 16.3.1.